

Your First 30 Days

A gentle, day by day map for your first month

Prepared for Mark Strazisar

This is your map for the first month, Mark. It is built to be gentle. Some days you will have energy and get a lot done. Some days you will rest. Both are part of the plan. Rest days are written into this schedule on purpose, because a sustainable pace beats a fast one that burns you out.

The rule for the whole month is simple. **You measure progress in documents finished, not hours worked.** One finished document is a real win. By the end of week two you will have a small portfolio. By the end of week four you will have had the conversation that turns this into income.

There is no revenue goal this month. The first month is about two things. Proving to yourself that you can do this, because you can. And getting real documents into your hands so you walk into every conversation with proof instead of an idea.

Week 1. Set up and prove it to yourself

This week you get the tools working and you finish your first document. That is the whole week. Here it is day by day, with rest built in.

Day 1. Set up Claude. About 30 minutes.

- Go to claude.ai and create an account.
- Subscribe to Claude Pro, about 20 dollars a month.
- Download the desktop app, sometimes called Cowork, and sign in.
- That is the whole day. You are set up. Close the laptop and rest.

Day 2. Set up your folders and read your samples. About 30 minutes.

- Make your main folder, My Documents Business, with the folders Clients, Finished, Templates, and Samples inside it.
- Open the two finished samples in the Tools and Examples folder. Read the server training manual and the opening checklist. See how a finished document looks and feels.
- That is it. Now you know your target.

Day 3. Rest or read.

- No task. If you feel good, reread the Start Here playbook, document 3. If not, rest with no guilt. The work waits.

Day 4. Make your first document, the talking part. About 20 minutes.

- Open the desktop app. Open the Copy and Paste Prompts document from the Tools and Examples folder and paste in the prompt for a training manual or a checklist.
- Talk for about ten minutes about how the job really works. Do not aim for perfect. Just get it out of your head.
- Tell Claude to write it up. Read the first draft once. Stop there for the day.

Day 5. Finish your first document, the review part. About 20 minutes.

- Reread the draft. Fix anything that is not how you really do it. Two or three rounds.
- When it sounds like you, save it in Finished, and save a clean copy in Templates with the names removed.
- You now have your first finished document. That is a real win. Take it in.

Days 6 and 7. Rest.

- The weekend is yours. Do not work. You proved the most important thing this week, that you can do this. Let it sit.

End of week 1 target: Claude set up, folders made, one finished document. If it took longer, that is fine. Move the rest forward and keep going.

Week 2. Build a small portfolio and shape your pitch

This week you finish two or three more documents and you get your pitch ready. Work in short bursts. Aim for one document every couple of days, with rest days between.

- **Finish a second document.** Pick something different from your first, so your samples show range. If your first was a training manual, do a checklist or a procedure this time.
- **Finish a third document** if you have the energy. Three finished documents is a real portfolio.
- **Pick your pitch version.** Open the Start Here playbook to the pitch section. Choose Version A if you are still on salary, or Version B if you are off work right now. Read it out loud once or twice until it feels natural in your own words.
- **Pick your proof piece.** Decide which one finished document you will show first. The server training manual or the opening checklist for a burger and beer style concept are strong choices, because the group has exactly that kind of spot.
- **Build in rest.** Two or three working sessions this week is plenty. Rest the rest.

End of week 2 target: two or three finished documents, pitch chosen and practiced once out loud.

Week 3. Have the conversation

This is the week you talk to the group. It is one calm conversation, not a hard sell. You already work there, or you recently did. You are offering to solve a problem you can see clearly.

- **Pick the right person.** Whoever you report to, or the operations leader, or your former manager if you are off work. One on one, calm, not rushed.

- **Have the conversation.** Use your practiced pitch. Lead with the problem they already feel, that openings and training get rebuilt from scratch. Point to your track record. Make the lane clear, that this is floor operations and does not touch HR or recruiting. Offer one free sample.
- **Show your proof piece.** Hand them the finished sample. Let them hold it and flip through it. A real document is far harder to say no to than an idea.
- **Ask for one small yes.** Not a contract. Just "can I build one document for you and you tell me if it is useful."
- **Then rest.** You did the hard part. Let them sit with it.

End of week 3 target: the first conversation had, one free sample offered.

Week 4. Land the arrangement or start the build

This week you turn interest into something real, or you keep the momentum going if they need time.

- **If they said yes to a sample,** build the one document they asked for and deliver it clean and polished. Then talk about an ongoing arrangement, and steer toward the monthly retainer described in the Start Here playbook.
- **If they want to move forward,** agree on the shape of it in writing using the Simple Agreement and Scope document in the Tools and Examples folder. Spell out what a month includes, so the work cannot creep bigger than you agreed. The retainer is your best option, because it gives you steady income and protects you on slow weeks. If you are still on salary, get a friendly yes in writing first, as the Start Here playbook explains.
- **Start the flagship.** Begin the new location opening playbook, your most valuable product. Even a rough start counts.
- **If they need more time,** that is fine. Keep finishing documents for your library, and remember your samples work at any other group in Denver too. You are not stuck waiting on one yes.

End of week 4 target: an arrangement agreed or in motion, and the opening playbook started.

If a week slips

If you get to the end of a week and you did not hit the target, nothing is wrong. You are managing your health first, and that is the right call every time. Just slide the plan forward a week and keep going. The order of the steps matters. The exact timing does not.

The retainer model is built for exactly this. Once you are on it, a slow week costs you nothing, because you are paid for the finished work over the month, not by the hour. Get yourself onto that

footing and the pressure comes off for good.

One finished document at a time, Mark. That is the whole game.